

KYC Verification API Guide

Identity & Corporate Due Diligence API — REST Reference v1.0

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Overview

The Cellion One KYC API lets you verify individuals and corporate entities programmatically. Use it to run BVN/ NIN lookups, full biometric KYC, and supplier due-diligence — all via a secure REST interface authenticated by API key.

Base URL

```
https://cellionone.com/api/v1/kyc
```

Authentication

Include your API key in every request using the X-API-Key header. Keys use the `co_live_` prefix followed by 32 hex characters. The full key is shown once at creation — store it securely.

```
curl -X GET https://cellionone.com/api/v1/kyc/templates \  
-H "X-API-Key: co_live_a1b2c3d4e5f6g7h8i9j0k1l2m3n4o5p6" \  
-H "Content-Type: application/json"
```

Rate Limits

Default: 60 requests per minute per API key. Exceeding this returns 429 Too Many Requests. Contact us to increase limits for high-volume integrations.

Credit Pricing

Cellion One uses a credit-based model — 1 credit = 1 verification, deducted automatically when a verification completes.

identity_only	15,000 / credit	BVN/NIN lookup + AML screening	Instant
individual	15,000 / credit	Full ID + biometric + AML	~2–5 min (webhook)
supplier	75,000 / credit	Corporate entity + director KYC + AML	~1 business day

Endpoints — Instant ID Lookups

POST /api/v1/kyc/lookup/bvn Verify a BVN against NIBSS

Required scope: verify:identity. Returns verified name, DOB, phone, gender, address, and government photo (if available). Deducts 1 identity_only credit.

```
{
  "idNumber": "222000000000",
  "firstName": "Emeka",
  "lastName": "Okoro",
  "dateOfBirth": "1990-01-15"
}
```

Response:

```
{
  "verified": true,
  "idType": "BVN",
  "referenceId": "id_lookup_1_1700000000_ab12cd34",
  "requestId": 42,
  "fullName": "EMEKA OKORO",
  "dob": "1990-01-15",
  "phone": "080XXXXXXX",
  "gender": "M",
  "address": "12 Marina Street, Lagos"
}
```

Same parameters and response shape as the BVN endpoint — substituting NIN for idNumber.

POST /api/v1/kyc/lookup/drivers-licence Verify a driver's licence against FRSC

Required scope: verify:identity. firstName, lastName, and dateOfBirth are all required for driver's licence lookups.

POST /api/v1/kyc/lookup/voter-id Verify a voter ID against INEC

Required scope: verify:identity. firstName, lastName, and dateOfBirth are all required.

Endpoints — Full KYC Sessions

POST /api/v1/kyc/requests Create a verification request

Required scope: verify:request. Accepts templateId, subjectEmail, subjectName, and subjectPhone. Returns a requestId and an inviteUrl (hosted session link you can email to your end-user).

```
{
  "templateId": 1,
  "subjectEmail": "customer@example.com",
  "subjectName": "Amaka Nwachukwu",
  "subjectPhone": "0801234567"
}
```

GET /api/v1/kyc/requests List all requests for your organisation

Returns paginated list of requests. Supports ?limit= and ?offset= query parameters.

GET /api/v1/kyc/requests/:requestId Get a single verification request

Returns the full request record including status, result, and any verified identity snapshot.

GET /api/v1/kyc/templates

Templates define the verification flow (which checks to run). You can create and manage templates in the KYC dashboard or via the API.

Webhook Events

Register a webhook URL in your organisation settings. Cellion One signs all payloads with HMAC-SHA256 (X-Cellion-Signature header). Verify the signature before processing.

```
{
  "event": "verification.completed",
  "requestId": 42,
  "status": "verified",
  "subjectEmail": "customer@example.com",
  "verificationType": "individual",
  "verifiedAt": "2026-04-12T10:30:00Z",
  "result": {
    "fullName": "AMAKA NWACHUKWU",
    "dob": "1988-06-20",
    "gender": "F"
  }
}
```

Error Codes

INSUFFICIENT_CREDITS	402	No credits remaining for this verification type
INVALID_API_KEY	401	API key is missing, malformed, or revoked
FORBIDDEN_SCOPE	403	API key lacks the required permission scope
NOT_FOUND	404	The requested resource does not exist
VALIDATION_ERROR	400	Request body failed schema validation
RATE_LIMIT_EXCEEDED	429	Too many requests — slow down and retry

Upstream identity provider returned an error

Support

For API support and integration guidance, contact:

service@cellionone.com

<https://cellionone.com/api-docs>